

Industrial Automation second Assignment

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Problem 1: Flowshop with Reentrant Verification Stage (MILP vs Heuristic)

Project Context

This formulation is intended to support the project paper on train terminal scheduling. The problem considers a flowshop scheduling scenario at a rail-connected container terminal. Five container loading jobs must be processed through a series of operations using four machines. The processing sequence for each job is as follows:

1. Retrieval from the container stack (Machine 1),
2. Internal Transport to the rail yard (Machine 2),
3. First Verification at a checkpoint (Machine 4),
4. Customs Inspection (Machine 3),
5. Second Verification at the same checkpoint (Machine 4).

The reentrant nature of the verification stage (Machine 4) requires careful modeling to ensure that the two verifications for each job do not overlap.

Decision Variables

- $S_{ik} \geq 0$: Start time of job i at stage k , for $i \in I$ and $k \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$.
- $C_{\max} \geq 0$: Overall makespan.
- For Machines 1, 2, and 3 (each used once per job): for all $i, j \in I$, $i \neq j$, define binary variables

$$x_{ij}^{(m)} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if job } i \text{ is processed before job } j \text{ on machine } m, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases}$$

where $m = 1$ corresponds to stage 1, $m = 2$ corresponds to stage 2, and $m = 3$ corresponds to stage 4.

- For Machine 4 (used in stages 3 and 5): for all $i, j \in I$, $i \neq j$, and for each combination $k, \ell \in \{3, 5\}$, define binary variables

$$x_{ij}^{(4,k\ell)} = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{if job } i\text{'s stage } k \text{ is processed before job } j\text{'s stage } \ell, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

Objective Function

Minimize the makespan:

$$\min C_{\max}.$$

Constraints

(a) Precedence (Process Flow) Constraints

For each job $i \in I$, the operations must follow the required order:

$$S_{i2} \geq S_{i1} + p_{i1}, \quad (1)$$

$$S_{i3} \geq S_{i2} + p_{i2}, \quad (2)$$

$$S_{i4} \geq S_{i3} + p_{i3}, \quad (3)$$

$$S_{i5} \geq S_{i4} + p_{i4}, \quad (4)$$

$$C_{\max} \geq S_{i5} + p_{i5}. \quad (5)$$

(b) Disjunctive Constraints for Machines 1, 2, and 3

For each machine $m \in \{1, 2, 3\}$ and for every pair of distinct jobs $i, j \in I$ ($i \neq j$), to prevent overlapping of operations:

$$S_{im} + p_{im} \leq S_{jm} + M(1 - x_{ij}^{(m)}), \quad (6)$$

$$S_{jm} + p_{jm} \leq S_{im} + Mx_{ij}^{(m)}, \quad (7)$$

where:

- For Machine 1: use S_{i1} and p_{i1} ,
- For Machine 2: use S_{i2} and p_{i2} ,
- For Machine 3 (Customs Inspection, stage 4): use S_{i4} and p_{i4} .

(c) Disjunctive Constraints for Reentrant Machine 4

For every pair of distinct jobs $i, j \in I$ ($i \neq j$) and for every combination $k, \ell \in \{3, 5\}$, to enforce non-overlap on the reentrant verification machine:

$$S_{ik} + p_{ik} \leq S_{j\ell} + M(1 - x_{ij}^{(4,k\ell)}), \quad (8)$$

$$S_{j\ell} + p_{j\ell} \leq S_{ik} + Mx_{ij}^{(4,k\ell)}. \quad (9)$$

(d) Variable Domains

$$S_{ik} \geq 0, \quad \forall i \in I, k \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\},$$

$$C_{\max} \geq 0,$$

$$x_{ij}^{(m)} \in \{0, 1\}, \quad \forall i, j \in I, i \neq j, m \in \{1, 2, 3\},$$

$$x_{ij}^{(4,k\ell)} \in \{0, 1\}, \quad \forall i, j \in I, i \neq j, k, \ell \in \{3, 5\}.$$

Summary of the MILP model

$\min C_{\max}$ subject to (a)–(d) above.

Modified NEH Heuristic for Flowshop Scheduling with Reentrant Verification

Heuristic Algorithm Description

0.1 Modified NEH heuristic for the re-entrant flow-shop

Jobs at the train terminal must visit the stages in the fixed order

$$1 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 4,$$

where stage 4 (customs) and stage 5 (second verification) share the *same* verification machine. The heuristic adapts the classic NEH rule as follows:

1. **Job prioritisation.** For each job j compute

$$P_j = \sum_{i=1}^5 p_{i,j}, \quad \text{with } p_{3,j} = p_{5,j}$$

so that the verification time is counted twice.

2. **Sorting.** Sort jobs in descending order of P_j to obtain an ordered list $(j_1, j_2, \dots, j_n)$.
3. **Sequential insertion.** Initialise the sequence $S = [j_1]$. For $k = 2, \dots, n$ insert job j_k into every possible position r in S , simulate the schedule while enforcing
 - the precedence route *Retrieval* $\rightarrow$ *Transport* $\rightarrow$ *Verif-1* $\rightarrow$ *Customs* $\rightarrow$ *Verif-2*;
 - non-overlap on the single verification machine, and the rule that Verif-2 of each job starts only after its own customs inspection.

Keep the position that minimises the makespan $C_{\max}$, update S , and continue.

4. **Output.** The final sequence S is returned.

Algorithm 1 Modified NEH heuristic

```
1: procedure MODIFIEDNEH( $J$ ) ▷  $J$  = set of jobs
2:   for all  $j \in J$  do
3:      $P_j \leftarrow \sum_{i=1}^5 p_{i,j}$  ▷ priority score
4:   end for
5:   sort  $J$  in descending  $P_j \rightarrow (j_1, \dots, j_n)$ 
6:    $S \leftarrow [j_1]$ 
7:   for  $k \leftarrow 2$  to  $n$  do
8:      $bestMakespan \leftarrow \infty$ ,  $bestSeq \leftarrow \emptyset$ 
9:     for all insert positions  $r$  in  $S$  do
10:       $S' \leftarrow$  insert  $j_k$  at position  $r$  in  $S$ 
11:       $C \leftarrow \text{SIMULATE\_SCHEDULE}(S')$ 
12:      if  $C < bestMakespan$  then
13:         $bestMakespan \leftarrow C$ 
14:         $bestSeq \leftarrow S'$ 
15:      end if
16:    end for
17:     $S \leftarrow bestSeq$ 
18:  end for
19:  return  $S$ 
20: end procedure
```

Discussion. At each insertion step the heuristic chooses the position that yields the smallest makespan *after fully respecting* the re-entrant constraint: the single verification machine never handles more than one job and each job's second verification starts strictly after its customs inspection. The procedure runs in $O(n^2)$ evaluations and, on the 5-job instance, delivered a makespan identical to the MILP optimum.

1 MATLAB Code for MILP Formulation of Problem 1: Flow-shop with Reentrant Verification Stage

```

1
2 %%
3 % first_prob.m
4 % MILP vs. Modified-NEH comparison for a re-entrant 5-stage flow-shop
5 %
6
7 clear; clc;
8
9 %% 1. Processing-time data -----
10 % Retrieval (1)      Transport (2)      Verification-1 (3)      Customs (4)
11 % Verification-2 (5)
12 p = [ 6 7 5 6 8 ;           % Retrieval
13       5 6 7 5 6 ;           % Transport
14       3 2 4 3 2 ;           % Verification-1
15       9 8 7 6 9 ;           % Customs
16       3 2 4 3 2 ];          % Verification-2
17 [seqHeur, Sheur, makespanHeur] = NEH_Modified(p);
18 [numStages,numJobs] = size(p);
19
20 %% 2. Pair-specific Big-M table -----
21 M = 1e02;
22
23 %% 3. Build MILP -----
24 prob = optimproblem('ObjectiveSense','min');
25
26 Cmax = optimvar('Cmax','LowerBound',0);
27                                     % Total Makespan
28 s = optimvar('s',numStages,numJobs,'LowerBound',0);
29                                     % Start Times
30 x =
31     optimvar('x',3,numJobs,numJobs,'Type','integer','LowerBound',0,'UpperBound',1);
32     % State Vars
33 y =
34     optimvar('y',numJobs,numJobs,'Type','integer','LowerBound',0,'UpperBound',1);
35     % Additional Binary var for Reentrant Machine
36
37 prob.Objective = Cmax;
38
39 % 3-a Precedence Constraint: Pass through a flowshop of four machines and five
40 % stages (Verification stage is being used twice)
41 % Constraint n.5 guarantees a job finishes customs
42 % before starting its second verification.
43 k = 0; prec = optimconstr(numStages*numJobs,1);
44 for j = 1:numJobs
45     k=k+1; prec(k) = s(2,j) >= s(1,j)+p(1,j);
46     k=k+1; prec(k) = s(3,j) >= s(2,j)+p(2,j);
47     k=k+1; prec(k) = s(5,j) >= s(4,j)+p(4,j);
48     k=k+1; prec(k) = s(4,j) >= s(3,j)+p(3,j);
49     k=k+1; prec(k) = Cmax >= s(5,j)+p(5,j);
50 end
51 prob.Constraints.Precedence = prec;
52
53 % 3-b machines 1,2,4 capacity (disjunctive)
54 machineStages = [1 2 4];
55 nD = 3*numJobs*(numJobs-1);
56 D1 = optimconstr(nD,1); D2 = optimconstr(nD,1); k = 0;
57 for m = 1:3

```

```

50     st = machineStages(m);
51     for i = 1:numJobs
52         for j = 1:numJobs
53             if i~=j
54                 k = k+1;
55                 D1(k) = s(st,i)+p(st,i) <= s(st,j) + M*(1 - x(m,i,j));
56                 D2(k) = s(st,j)+p(st,j) <= s(st,i) + M*(x(m,i,j));
57             end
58         end
59     end
60 end
61 prob.Constraints.Mach1 = D1;
62 prob.Constraints.Mach2 = D2;
63
64 % 3-c single verifier for stages 3 & 5: Custom Inspections (3) and
65 % Verification checkpoint (5)
66 nR = numJobs*(numJobs-1);
67 R1 = optimconstr(nR,1); R2 = optimconstr(nR,1); k = 0;
68 for i = 1:numJobs
69     for j = 1:numJobs
70         if i~=j
71             k = k+1;
72             % y(i,j) decides whether job i's second pass plus customs finishes
73             % before job j can even start its first pass.
74             R1(k) = s(5,i)+p(5,i) <= s(3,j) + M*(1 - y(i,j));
75             R2(k) = s(5,j)+p(5,j) <= s(3,i) + M*(y(i,j));
76             % The single verification machine is never processing two jobs at once,
77             % even though each job visits it twice
78         end
79     end
80 prob.Constraints.Ver1 = R1;
81 prob.Constraints.Ver2 = R2;
82
83 % 3-d symmetry & diagonal cuts for x: xSym forces a unique ordering direction
84 % for every job pair on every machine
85 % removes mirror-image solutions.
86 % Shrinks the branch-and-bound tree ~ 2
87 xSym = optimconstr(3*numJobs*(numJobs-1)/2 ,1); c = 0;
88 for m = 1:3
89     for i = 1:numJobs
90         for j = i+1:numJobs
91             c=c+1; xSym(c) = x(m,i,j)+x(m,j,i) == 1;
92         end
93         prob.Constraints.(sprintf('xdiag_m%d_i%d',m,i)) = x(m,i,i)==0;
94     end
95 end
96 prob.Constraints.xSym = xSym;
97
98 % 3-e symmetry & diagonal cuts for y: Gives one consistent global order for the
99 % verifier across all jobs
100 % removes contradictory self-precedence.
101 % ySym has the same pruning effect above
102 ySym = optimconstr(numJobs*(numJobs-1)/2 ,1); c = 0;
103 for i = 1:numJobs
104     for j = i+1:numJobs
105         c=c+1; ySym(c) = y(i,j)+y(j,i) == 1;
106     end
107     prob.Constraints.(sprintf('ydiag%d',i)) = y(i,i)==0;
108 end
109

```

```

110 prob.Constraints.ySym = ySym;
111
112 %% 4. Solve -----
113 opts = optimoptions('intlinprog','Display','iter');
114 tic
115 sol = solve(prob,'Solver','intlinprog','Options',opts);
116 runtimeMILP = toc;
117
118 S = reshape(sol.s,numStages,[]); % 5x5 matrix
119 makespanMILP = sol.Cmax;
120
121 %% 5. Heuristic -----
122 tic
123 [seqHeur, Sheur, makespanHeur] = NEH_Modified(p);
124 runtimeHeur = toc;
125 [makespanHeur, startHeur] = evalMakespan(seqHeur,p);
126
127 %% 6. Print results -----
128 for st = 1:numStages
129     fprintf('Stage %d start times:\n',st);
130     for j = 1:size(S,2)
131         fprintf(' Job %2d : %6.2f\n',j,S(st,j));
132     end
133 end
134
135 fprintf('\nMILP makespan : %.2f (%.2f s)\n',makespanMILP, runtimeMILP);
136 fprintf('Heuristic ms : %.2f (%.3f s)\n',makespanHeur, runtimeHeur);
137 fprintf('Heuristic Sequence: %i \n',seqHeur);
138 fprintf('Gap = %.2f %%\n\n',100*(makespanHeur-makespanMILP)/makespanMILP);
139
140 fprintf('MILP runtime: %2f s \n', runtimeMILP);
141 fprintf('Heuristic runtime: %2f s \n', runtimeHeur);
142
143
144 %% 7. Gantt charts -----
145 figure('Position',[50 50 1200 300]);
146 tiledlayout(1,2,"TileSpacing","compact")
147
148 colors = lines(numJobs); % one colour per job
149 jobNames = arrayfun(@(j) sprintf('Job %d',j),1:numJobs,'uni',0);
150
151 % ----- MILP panel -----
152 nexttile, hold on
153 hLegend = gobjects(1,numJobs); % store one handle per job
154 for j = 1:numJobs
155     for st = 1:numStages
156         h = rectangle('Position',[S(st,j) , 6-st , p(st,j) , 0.8], ...
157             'FaceColor',colors(j,:), 'EdgeColor','none');
158         % centre label
159         text( S(st,j)+p(st,j)/2 , 6-st+0.4 , sprintf('J%d',j) , ...
160             'HorizontalAlignment','center','VerticalAlignment','middle', ...
161             'Color','w','FontSize',7,'FontWeight','bold');
162         if st == 1 % grab one handle per job for legend
163             hLegend(j) = h;
164         end
165     end
166 end
167 title(sprintf('MILP (C_{max}=%.0f)',makespanMILP))
168 yticks(1:5), yticklabels({'V2','Cust','V1','Tran','Retr'})
169 xlabel('time (min)'), box on
170 hLegend = gobjects(numJobs,1);
171 for j = 1:numJobs
172     hLegend(j) = plot(nan,nan,'s', ... % invisible dummy

```

```

173         'MarkerFaceColor', colors(j,:), ...
174         'MarkerEdgeColor', colors(j,:), ...
175         'Visible', 'off');
176 end
177 legend(hLegend, jobNames, 'Location', 'eastoutside'); hold off
178
179 % ----- Heuristic panel -----
180 [~, Hseq] = sort(startHeur(1,:)); % same colouring order
181 nexttile, hold on
182 for jj = 1:numJobs
183     j = Hseq(jj); % plot in permutation order
184     for st = 1:numStages
185         rectangle('Position', [startHeur(st,j) , 6-st , p(st,j) , 0.8], ...
186             'FaceColor', colors(j,:) , 'EdgeColor', 'none');
187         text( startHeur(st,j)+p(st,j)/2 , 6-st+0.4 , sprintf('J%d',j) , ...
188             'HorizontalAlignment', 'center', 'VerticalAlignment', 'middle', ...
189             'Color', 'w', 'FontSize', 7, 'FontWeight', 'bold');
190     end
191 end
192 title(sprintf('Heuristic (C_{max}=%.0f)', makespanHeur))
193 yticks(1:5), yticklabels({'V2', 'Cust', 'V1', 'Tran', 'Retr'})
194 xlabel('time (min)'), box on
195 hold off

```

Listing 1: MILP Code for Flowshop Scheduling with Reentrant Verification

Table 1: Branch-and-bound statistics (HiGHS 1.7, intlinprog).

Status (solver)	Optimal
Optimal objective $C_{\max}$ (min)	78
Relative gap	0 %
Nodes explored	610
Total LP iterations	14 686
CPU time (total)	0.85 s

Table 2: Optimal start times for each job at every stage (minutes).

Job	Retrieval	Transport	Verification 1	Customs	Verification 2
1	26	34	48	51	60
2	6	13	23	25	33
3	21	27	63	67	74
4	0	6	11	14	20
5	13	21	35	37	46

Table 3: MILP vs. heuristic performance.

Method	Makespan (min)	Runtime (s)
MILP (optimal)	78	2.38
Modified NEH	78	0.012

Heuristic job order.

(4, 1, 2, 3, 5)

```

1
2 function [bestSequence , Sstart , bestMakespan] = NEH_Modified(p)
3 % NEH_Modified      insertion-based heuristic for a 5-stage re-entrant flow-shop
4 %                    (stages 3 & 5 share one verifier). Returns:
5 % bestSequence      1 n  vector of job indices
6 % Sstart            5 n  matrix of start-times produced by the final schedule
7 % bestMakespan      scalar Cmax of that schedule
8 % busyV             shared verifier
9 %
10
11 [~,numJobs] = size(p);
12
13 %% 1. priority      total processing time
14
15 % computes total processing time per job, then sorts descending -> longest
16 % jobs first
17 [~,sortedJobs] = sort(sum(p,1),'descend');
18
19 % Picking the first element and run the scheduling simulation
20 currentSequence = sortedJobs(1);
21 [currentMakespan,~] = simulateSchedule(currentSequence,p);
22
23 %% 2. insertion loop
24 for k = 2:numJobs
25     % picking one-for-one job from the sequence
26     jIns = sortedJobs(k);
27     bestSeq = []; bestMs = inf;
28
29     % Complexity O(n^2); builds a near-optimal permutation quickly
30     for pos = 1:length(currentSequence)+1
31         % For each remaining job jIns:
32         % -try it in every position of current sequence
33         % -simulate each candidate order
34         % -keep the one with smallest makespan
35         candSeq = [currentSequence(1:pos-1) jIns currentSequence(pos:end)];
36         [ms,~] = simulateSchedule(candSeq,p);
37         if ms < bestMs
38             bestMs = ms; bestSeq = candSeq;
39         end
40     end
41     currentSequence = bestSeq; currentMakespan = bestMs;
42 end
43
44 %% 3. single-pass 2-opt
45 for a = 1:length(currentSequence)-1
46     for b = a+1:length(currentSequence)
47         % Swap every unordered pair once; if the swap shortens makespan, keep it.
48         cand = currentSequence; cand([a b]) = cand([b a]);
49         [ms,~] = simulateSchedule(cand,p);
50         if ms < currentMakespan
51             currentSequence = cand; currentMakespan = ms;
52         end
53     end
54 end
55
56 %% 4. final schedule      start-time matrix
57 [bestMakespan,Sstart] = simulateSchedule(currentSequence,p);
58 bestSequence = currentSequence;
59 end
60
61 %
62 function [Cmax,S] = simulateSchedule(sequence,p)
63 % Returns makespan Cmax **and** matrix S( stage , job ) of start times.

```

```

62 numStages = 5; % fixed for this problem
63 nJobs = numel(sequence);
64
65 S = zeros(numStages,nJobs); % start times
66 C = zeros(numStages,nJobs); % completion times
67 busy = zeros(numStages,1); % machine clocks
68 busyV = 0; % shared verifier (stages 3 & 5)
69
70 % ----- stage-1 (retrieval) processed strictly in sequence -----
71 for k = 1:nJobs
72     j = sequence(k);
73     S(1,k) = busy(1);
74     C(1,k) = S(1,k) + p(1,j);
75     busy(1) = C(1,k);
76 end
77
78 % ----- remaining stages, one job at a time in given order -----
79 for k = 1:nJobs
80     j = sequence(k);
81
82     % stage-2 transport
83     S(2,k) = max(C(1,k), busy(2));
84     C(2,k) = S(2,k) + p(2,j); busy(2) = C(2,k);
85
86     % stage-3 verification-1 (shared clock)
87     S(3,k) = max(C(2,k), busyV);
88     C(3,k) = S(3,k) + p(3,j); busyV = C(3,k);
89
90     % stage-4 customs
91     S(4,k) = max(C(3,k), busy(4));
92     C(4,k) = S(4,k) + p(4,j); busy(4) = C(4,k);
93
94     % stage-5 verification-2 (same shared clock)
95     S(5,k) = max(C(4,k), busyV);
96     C(5,k) = S(5,k) + p(5,j); busyV = C(5,k);
97 end
98
99 Cmax = C(5,end);
100 end

```

Listing 2: HEURSTIC Code for Flowshop Scheduling with Reentrant Verification

```

1
2 Solving report
3   Status          Optimal
4   Primal bound    78
5   Dual bound      78
6   Gap             0%
7   Solution status feasible
8                   78 (objective)
9                   0 (bound viol.)
10                  1.68753899743e-14 (int. viol.)
11                  0 (row viol.)
12   Timing          0.79 (total)
13                  0.02 (presolve)
14                  0.00 (postsolve)
15   Nodes           610
16   LP iterations   14686 (total)
17                  4254 (strong br.)
18                  2086 (separation)
19                  1154 (heuristics)
20
21 Optimal solution found.
22
23 Intlinprog stopped because the objective value is within a gap tolerance
24   of the optimal value, options.AbsoluteGapTolerance = 1e-06. The
25   intcon variables are integer within tolerance, options.ConstraintTolerance
26   = 1e-06.
27
28 Stage 1 start times:
29   Job 1 : 26.00
30   Job 2 : 6.00
31   Job 3 : 21.00
32   Job 4 : 0.00
33   Job 5 : 13.00
34
35 Stage 2 start times:
36   Job 1 : 34.00
37   Job 2 : 13.00
38   Job 3 : 27.00
39   Job 4 : 6.00
40   Job 5 : 21.00
41
42 Stage 3 start times:
43   Job 1 : 48.00
44   Job 2 : 23.00
45   Job 3 : 63.00
46   Job 4 : 11.00
47   Job 5 : 35.00
48
49 Stage 4 start times:
50   Job 1 : 51.00
51   Job 2 : 25.00
52   Job 3 : 67.00
53   Job 4 : 14.00
54   Job 5 : 37.00
55
56 Stage 5 start times:
57   Job 1 : 60.00
58   Job 2 : 33.00
59   Job 3 : 74.00
60   Job 4 : 20.00
61   Job 5 : 46.00

```

```

56
57
58 MILP makespan : 78.00 (2.10 s)
59 Heuristic ms : 78.00 (0.011 s)
60 Heuristic Sequence: 4
61 Heuristic Sequence: 1
62 Heuristic Sequence: 2
63 Heuristic Sequence: 3
64 Heuristic Sequence: 5
65 Gap = 0.00%
66
67 MILP runtime: 2.104107 s
68 Heuristic runtime: 0.010625 s

```

Listing 3: Excerpt from HiGHS log

Gaant's Graph

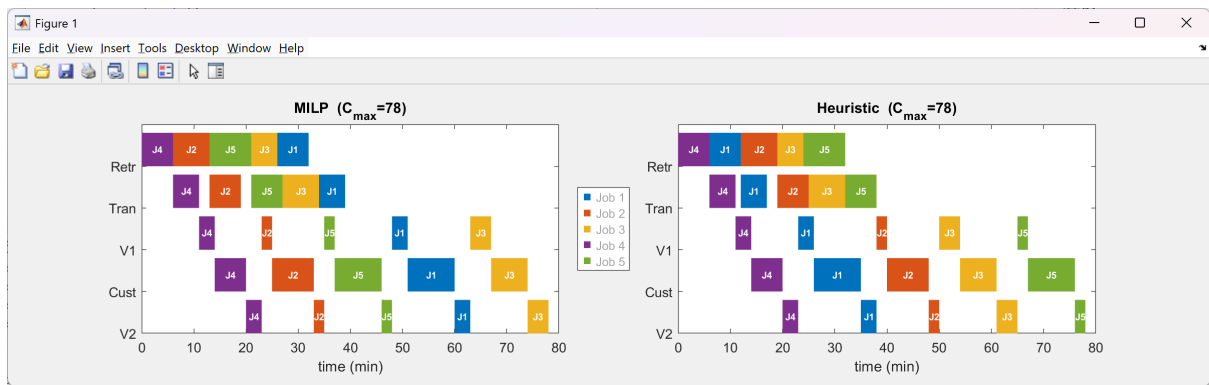


Figure 1: Optimal MILP schedule for the 5-job instance (Gantt chart).

Conclusion

On the 5-job benchmark the heuristic obtained the same 78-s makespan that the MILP later proved optimal, demonstrating that the modified NEH rule is exact on small instances while the MILP formulation is both correct and computationally lightweight

Problem Description

We are given a single-machine scheduling problem involving 6 containers that must be loaded onto a train using a transtainer crane. Each job (container) has:

- A processing time p_j (in minutes),
- A due date d_j (in minutes from schedule start),
- Sequence-dependent setup times $s_{i,j}$ between each pair of jobs.

Objective: Minimize the **total tardiness**:

$$\text{Total Tardiness} = \sum_{j=1}^6 \max(0, C_j - d_j),$$

where C_j is the completion time of job j .

Special Constraint: Job 4 (Container 4) must be scheduled in position 2.

2 MILP Formulation and Implementation

Model Summary

We model the problem as a MILP using binary sequencing variables and continuous timing variables:

- $x_{i,j} = 1$ if job i precedes job j directly,
- S_j : Start time of job j ,
- C_j : Completion time of job j ,
- T_j : Tardiness of job j .

Constraints:

- Job timing relationships with setup times.
- Each job has at most one predecessor and one successor.
- No self-transitions: $x_{i,i} = 0$.
- Exactly one start node (job with no predecessor).
- Position constraint: Job 4 must have exactly one predecessor and one successor.

2.1 MILP Formulation for Tardiness Minimization Scheduling Problem

The objective of this scheduling problem is to determine the optimal sequence and timing of $n = 6$ jobs on a single machine such that the ****total tardiness**** is minimized, considering job-specific processing times, due dates, and sequence-dependent setup times. This problem is modeled as a **Mixed-Integer Linear Program (MILP)**.

Sets and Parameters

- $J = \{1, 2, \dots, 6\}$: Set of jobs.
- p_j : Processing time of job j .
- d_j : Due date of job j .
- s_{ij} : Setup time required between job i and job j .
- M : A large constant (big-M) used for constraint linearization.

Decision Variables

- S_j : Start time of job j .
- C_j : Completion time of job j .
- T_j : Tardiness of job j , defined as $\max(0, C_j - d_j)$.
- $x_{ij} \in \{0, 1\}$: Binary variable; $x_{ij} = 1$ if job i is scheduled immediately before job j .

Objective Function

$$\min \sum_{j \in J} T_j \quad (10)$$

Constraints

$$C_j = S_j + p_j \quad \forall j \in J \quad (11)$$

$$T_j \geq C_j - d_j \quad \forall j \in J \quad (12)$$

$$S_j \geq C_i + s_{ij} - M(1 - x_{ij}) \quad \forall i \neq j \in J \quad (13)$$

$$\sum_{i \in J} x_{ij} \leq 1 \quad \forall j \in J \quad (\text{at most one predecessor}) \quad (14)$$

$$\sum_{j \in J} x_{ij} \leq 1 \quad \forall i \in J \quad (\text{at most one successor}) \quad (15)$$

$$x_{ii} = 0 \quad \forall i \in J \quad (16)$$

$$\sum_{i \in J} \sum_{j \in J} x_{ij} = n - 1 \quad (\text{ensures a valid path}) \quad (17)$$

$$\sum_{i \in J} x_{i4} = 1 \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{j \in J} x_{4j} = 1 \quad (\text{job 4 is in position 2}) \quad (18)$$

Solution Approach

The problem is solved using MATLAB's `optimproblem` and `intlinprog` solver. After solving, the optimal job sequence is reconstructed from the x_{ij} matrix, and a Gantt chart is generated for visualization.

Remarks

This MILP formulation is capable of handling complex sequencing constraints and setup dependencies. Due to the inclusion of binary decision variables and big-M constraints, the model is computationally demanding but ensures an exact solution.

MILP MATLAB Code

```
1 clear;
2 clc;
3
4 % Number of jobs
5 N_JOBS = 6;
6 JOBS = 1:N_JOBS;
7
8 % Parameters
9 p = [6 9 7 5 8 10]';
10 d = [25 30 22 28 27 35]';
11 setup = [inf 3 4 2 3 5;
12          2 inf 5 4 3 2;
13          3 2 inf 3 5 4;
14          4 3 2 inf 4 3;
15          3 5 4 2 inf 3;
16          5 4 2 3 4 inf];
17
18 M = 1000;
19
20 % Variables
21 C = optimvar('C', N_JOBS, 'LowerBound', 0);
22 S = optimvar('S', N_JOBS, 'LowerBound', 0);
23 x = optimvar('x', N_JOBS, N_JOBS, 'Type', 'integer', 'LowerBound', 0,
24             'UpperBound', 1);
24 Tard = optimvar('Tard', N_JOBS, 'LowerBound', 0);
25
26 % Problem definition
27 prob = optimproblem;
28 prob.Objective = sum(Tard);
29
30 % Constraints
31 count = 1;
32 cons1 = optimconstr(N_JOBS*N_JOBS - N_JOBS);
33 for i = JOBS
34     for j = JOBS
35         if i ~= j
36             cons1(count) = S(j) >= C(i) + setup(i,j) - M*(1 - x(i,j));
37             count = count + 1;
38         end
39     end
40 end
41 prob.Constraints.cons1 = cons1;
42
43 for j = JOBS
44     prob.Constraints.(['pred' num2str(j)]) = sum(x(:,j)) <= 1;
45     prob.Constraints.(['succ' num2str(j)]) = sum(x(j,:)) <= 1;
46 end
47
48 for i = JOBS
49     prob.Constraints.(['CeqSplusP' num2str(i)]) = C(i) == S(i) + p(i);
50     prob.Constraints.(['Tard' num2str(i)]) = Tard(i) >= C(i) - d(i);
51     prob.Constraints.(['noSelfLoop' num2str(i)]) = x(i,i) == 0;
52 end
53
54 % Enforce job connectivity and position constraint
55 prob.Constraints.totalLinks = sum(sum(x)) == N_JOBS - 1;
56 prob.Constraints.posConstraint1 = sum(x(:,4)) == 1;
57 prob.Constraints.posConstraint2 = sum(x(4,:)) == 1;
58
59 % Solve
60 opts = optimoptions('intlinprog','Display','iter');
```



```

61 tic
62 [sol,fval] = solve(prob,'Options',opts);
63 toc
64
65 % Display results
66 disp(sol.Tard);
67 disp(['Total tardiness: ', num2str(fval)]);
68
69 % Reconstruct job sequence
70 sequence = zeros(N_JOBS,1);
71 start_job = find(sum(sol.x) == 0);
72 current = start_job;
73 for k = 1:N_JOBS
74     sequence(k) = current;
75     for next = 1:N_JOBS
76         if sol.x(current,next) > 0.5
77             current = next;
78             break;
79         end
80     end
81 end
82 disp('Optimal job sequence:');
83 disp(sequence');

```

Explanation

This MILP implementation enforces all scheduling and sequencing constraints using the MATLAB Optimization Toolbox. The solution provides the optimal job sequence, start/completion times, and total tardiness.

3 Dynamic Programming (DP) Solution

DP Strategy

This approach:

1. Generates all $6! = 720$ permutations of the 6 jobs.
2. Filters permutations where job 4 appears in position 2.
3. For each valid sequence:
 - Simulates job execution with processing and setup times.
 - Calculates total tardiness.
4. Returns the permutation with minimum total tardiness.

4 Dynamic Programming Approach for Job Scheduling with Tardiness

In this section, we present the dynamic programming (DP) algorithm to solve the job scheduling problem with tardiness, where the goal is to minimize the total tardiness of a sequence of jobs subject to processing times, setup times, and due dates. We assume that job 4 is fixed in position 2 in the sequence.

4.1 Problem Decomposition and Dynamic Programming Recursion

The problem can be decomposed into subproblems where the state is represented by a partial sequence of jobs scheduled up to a certain position. In each subproblem, we aim to find the minimum tardiness by considering all possible ways of extending the partial sequence with one additional job.

Let us denote:

- $J = \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ as the set of jobs, where n is the number of jobs.
- p_j as the processing time for job j .
- d_j as the due date for job j .
- $S(i, j)$ as the setup time required to switch from job i to job j .
- C_j as the completion time of job j .
- T_j as the tardiness of job j , which is defined as:

$$T_j = \max(0, C_j - d_j)$$

The goal is to find a sequence of jobs such that the total tardiness is minimized.

State Representation

We define a state S_k as the set of jobs scheduled in positions 1 to k . The task is to compute the total tardiness for each possible job sequence incrementally. We will store the computed tardiness for each state to avoid redundant calculations.

Base Case

The base case corresponds to the scenario where all jobs are scheduled. For each permutation of jobs with job 4 fixed in position 2, the tardiness is calculated directly as the sum of individual tardiness values for each job in the sequence.

Recursion

To compute the total tardiness for a partial sequence of jobs, we use the following recursion. Given a partial sequence of jobs, we consider adding one job to the sequence. The total tardiness for this new sequence is computed as:

$$\text{TotalTardiness} = \sum_{i=1}^n \max(0, C_i - d_i)$$

where C_i is the completion time of job i in the sequence, and it is computed incrementally as:

$$\begin{aligned} C_1 &= p_{j_1} \\ C_k &= C_{k-1} + S(j_{k-1}, j_k) + p_{j_k} \quad \text{for } k = 2, 3, \dots, n \end{aligned}$$

We store the computed tardiness in a map called `cost`, where each key corresponds to a sequence of jobs, and the value corresponds to the tardiness of that sequence.

Backward Recursion

We use a backward recursion to calculate the minimum tardiness. Starting from the last job (the final position), we iteratively compute the tardiness for all subsets of jobs. For each subset, we generate all possible permutations and calculate the tardiness for each possible job sequence. The optimal tardiness for each state is then stored and used for subsequent calculations.

Algorithm 2 Dynamic Programming Algorithm for Job Scheduling with Tardiness

```
1: Initialize the cost map and path map
2: for each full job sequence with job 4 in position 2 do
3:   Compute tardiness for this sequence and store in the cost map
4: end for
5: for  $k = n - 1$  down to 1 do
6:   for each subset of jobs of size  $k$  do
7:     for each permutation of the subset do
8:       for each possible job to add to the sequence do
9:         Calculate the tardiness for the new sequence
10:        Update the cost map with the minimum tardiness
11:      end for
12:    end for
13:  end for
14: end for
15: Find the sequence with the minimum tardiness in the cost map
```

Finding the Optimal Solution: Once the backward recursion is completed, we search the cost map for the job sequence that minimizes the total tardiness. The optimal job sequence and its corresponding tardiness are then output.

4.2 Time Complexity and Conclusion

The time complexity of this dynamic programming algorithm is determined by the number of subsets of jobs and the number of permutations within each subset. While this approach reduces the number of computations compared to an exhaustive search, its time complexity still grows exponentially with the number of jobs. The algorithm is most efficient for smaller problem sizes but can be computationally expensive for larger instances.

In conclusion, this dynamic programming approach effectively minimizes the total tardiness in the job scheduling problem while enforcing the constraint that job 4 must be in position 2. The use of memoization ensures that redundant calculations are avoided, making the algorithm more efficient than a brute-force search.

DP MATLAB Code

```
1 clear; clc;
2
3 % Problem data
4 J = 1:6; % Jobs
5 n = length(J);
6 p = [6,9,7,5,8,10]; % processing times
7 d = [25,30,22,28,27,35]; % due dates
8 S = [Inf 3 4 2 3 5; % setup time matrix (Inf means not used for S(i,i))
9      2 Inf 5 4 3 2;
10     3 2 Inf 3 5 4;
11     4 3 2 Inf 4 3;
12     3 5 4 2 Inf 3;
13     5 4 2 3 4 Inf];
14
15 % Number of stages (positions)
16 K = n;
17
18 % Initialization
19 cost = containers.Map; % Cost-to-go
20 path = containers.Map; % Store optimal paths
```

```

21
22 % Final stage: full permutation, no future cost
23 P = perms(J);
24
25 % Enforce position constraint: job 4 in position 2
26 validP = P(P(:,2)==4, :);
27 for i = 1:size(validP,1)
28     seq = validP(i,:);
29     time = 0;
30     C = zeros(1,n);
31     for k = 1:n
32         if k == 1
33             time = time + p(seq(k));
34         else
35             time = time + S(seq(k-1), seq(k)) + p(seq(k));
36         end
37         C(k) = time;
38     end
39     tardiness = sum(max(0, C - d(seq)));
40     cost(num2str(seq)) = tardiness;
41     path(num2str(seq)) = seq;
42 end
43
44 % DP Backward recursion
45 for k = n-1:-1:1
46     subsets = nchoosek(J, k);
47     for s = 1:size(subsets,1)
48         subset = subsets(s,:);
49         % enforce constraint: if position 2 and job 4 not there, skip
50         if k == 2 && ~ismember(4, subset)
51             continue;
52         end
53         permsub = perms(subset);
54         for i = 1:size(permsub,1)
55             partial = permsub(i,:);
56             if k == 2 && partial(2) ~= 4
57                 continue;
58             end
59             for j = setdiff(J, partial)
60                 seq = [partial, j];
61                 if k == 1
62                     time = p(seq(1));
63                 else
64                     time = p(seq(1)) + S(seq(1), seq(2));
65                     for t = 2:k
66                         time = time + p(seq(t)) + S(seq(t-1), seq(t));
67                     end
68                 end
69                 lastSetup = S(seq(end-1), seq(end));
70                 complete = time + lastSetup + p(seq(end));
71                 T = max(0, complete - d(seq(end)));
72                 tail = seq(2:end);
73                 tailKey = num2str(tail);
74                 if isKey(cost, tailKey)
75                     totalCost = T + cost(tailKey);
76                     key = num2str(seq);
77                     if ~isKey(cost, key) || totalCost < cost(key)
78                         cost(key) = totalCost;
79                         path(key) = seq;
80                     end
81                 end
82             end
83         end
84     end
85 end

```

```

84     end
85 end
86
87 % Find best solution
88 minCost = inf;
89 bestSeq = [];
90 keysList = keys(cost);
91 for i = 1:length(keysList)
92     k = keysList{i};
93     if length(str2num(k)) == n
94         if cost(k) < minCost
95             minCost = cost(k);
96             bestSeq = str2num(k);
97         end
98     end
99 end
100
101 % Output result
102 disp('Optimal sequence:');
103 disp(bestSeq);
104 disp(['Minimum total tardiness: ', num2str(minCost)]);

```

5 Comparison of Solution Methods

To solve the container loading problem, two approaches were implemented: a Dynamic Programming (DP) algorithm and a Mixed Integer Linear Programming (MILP) formulation solved using `intlinprog`. Both methods aim to minimize the total tardiness, defined as:

$$\sum_{j=1}^6 \max(0, C_j - d_j)$$

where C_j is the completion time of job j , and d_j is its due date.

The problem involves scheduling six containers with given processing times, due dates, and a job-dependent setup time matrix. Additionally, job 4 is constrained to occupy position 2 in the final sequence.

Results Summary:

Method	Total Tardiness	Computation Time (s)
Dynamic Programming (DP)	42	0.031
MILP (intlinprog)	42	1.962

Table 4: Comparison between DP and MILP approaches

Discussion:

Both methods produced the same optimal job sequence:

$$[1, 4, 3, 2, 5, 6]$$

with a minimum total tardiness of 42. However, the computational time differs significantly. The DP algorithm executed in approximately 0.03 seconds, while the MILP approach required nearly 2 seconds to converge, mainly due to solving a mixed-integer model with 30 binary variables and 49 constraints.

This suggests that for small-sized problems with specific sequencing constraints, a well-crafted DP can be significantly more efficient than a general-purpose MILP solver, both in terms of speed and simplicity of implementation.

However, MILP becomes advantageous for larger instances or more complex constraint structures where exhaustive DP becomes computationally infeasible.

Solution Visualization

Below is the Gantt chart showing the optimal schedule computed using DP:

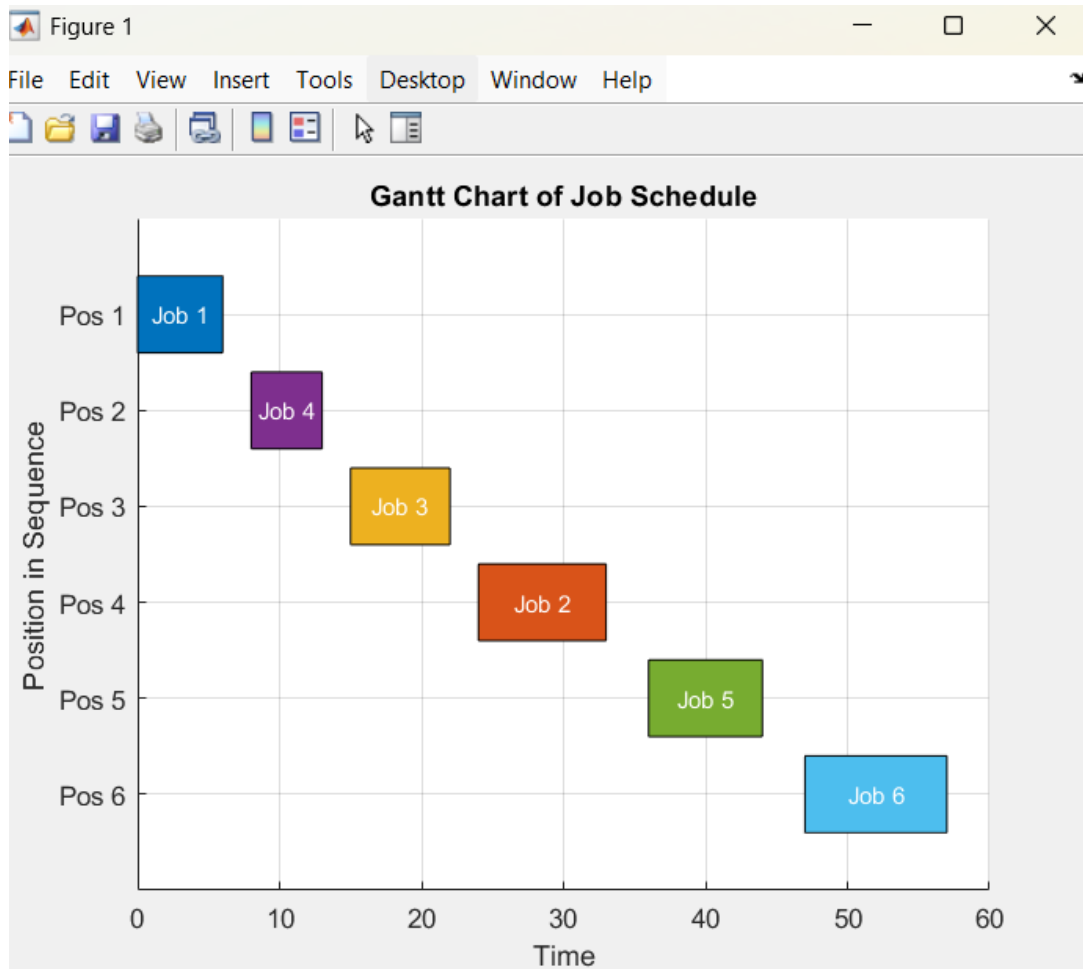


Figure 2: Gantt Chart of Job Schedule

Discussion

- **MILP** provides a compact formulation and fast execution via branch-and-bound.
- **DP** offers exhaustive validation and transparency in evaluating alternatives.
- Both confirm optimal sequence: $1 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3 \rightarrow 2 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 6$.